

VERSION 3.0 · WINDOWS

Audio Extractor

The Simple Guide

Drop a video onto one file. Seconds later you have the audio out of it, ready to listen to and ready to transcribe.

No uploads. No waiting. No subscription.

Drag & drop

That is the whole interface

~40 seconds

For a 3-hour lecture

Fully offline

Nothing leaves your machine

.mp3

To listen, and for NotebookLM

Mono at 96 kbps. Clear speech, and a 3-hour lecture lands near 130 MB, under NotebookLM's 200 MB cap.

.flac

To transcribe

16 kHz mono, volume-levelled. Built to go straight into your transcription pipeline.

WHAT IS INSIDE

PART 1	One-time setup	Install the engine, choose where files are saved
PART 2	Using it	Drag, drop, done. It takes seconds
PART 3	What you get	Two files, and which one to reach for
PART 4	When something goes wrong	Every message it can show you, and the fix
PART 5	Optional extras	Safe to ignore. Here for the day you need it

You only ever do this once. After it, the tool is just drag and drop, forever.

1

Install FFmpeg

Audio Extractor is the remote control. FFmpeg is the engine that does the actual work. Without it, nothing happens.

The easy way, on Windows 10 or 11:

1. Click Start, type `Terminal`, right-click it, choose **Run as administrator**.
2. Copy the line below, paste it in, and press Enter.

PASTE THIS

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

3. Wait for it to finish, then **close that window completely and open a new one**.
4. Check that it worked:

THEN THIS

```
ffmpeg -version
```

If you see a few lines of text beginning with `ffmpeg version`, you are done. If you see *not recognized*, use the manual way below instead.

1b

The manual way, only if the above did not work

1. Go to `gyan.dev/ffmpeg/builds` and download **ffmpeg-release-essentials.zip**.
2. Right-click the downloaded file and choose **Extract All**.
3. Open the extracted folder, then open the `bin` folder inside it.
4. You will see `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe`. You need **both**.
5. Copy both files into the same folder where you keep `Audio_Extractor.bat`.

That is all. Audio Extractor looks for them right next to itself, so there is nothing else to configure.

2

Choose where your finished files go

By default everything is saved to `F:\Lecture`. If you have an F: drive and that suits you, skip this step entirely.

1. Right-click `Audio_Extractor.bat` and choose **Edit**, or **Open with → Notepad**.
2. Near the top, find this line:

FIND

```
set "OUT_ROOT=F:\Lecture"
```

3. Change the path to anything you like:

CHANGE TO

```
set "OUT_ROOT=D:\My Lectures"
```

4. Save the file and close Notepad.

YOU CANNOT BREAK THIS

If the folder you pick does not exist or cannot be written to, the tool notices, says so on screen, and saves your files next to itself in a folder called `Extracted_Audio` instead. Nothing is ever lost.

PART 2 Using it

every time

1

Find your video or audio file

Anywhere on your computer. MP4, MKV, MOV, TS, MP3, M4A and the rest all work.

2

Drag it on top of Audio_Extractor.bat and let go

You can drop **several files at once**. Select them all, drag the whole group over, and the tool works through them one at a time.

3

Wait a few seconds

A black window opens, numbers move, and it is finished. A three-hour lecture takes roughly **40 seconds**, most often somewhere between 20 and 60.

4

Press any key to close

Your files are waiting in the output folder.

Why it is so much faster than an online converter

An online converter has to receive your entire video, convert it on somebody else's machine, and send the result back. The upload alone is usually the slowest part, and it can fail halfway and start over.

This tool never sends anything anywhere. The audio is already inside your video file as its own track; extracting it is mostly a matter of copying and re-packaging, not rebuilding. That is why a three-hour lecture is done before you have finished reading this paragraph.

Is my original file safe?

Yes. Audio Extractor only ever *reads* your original. It never moves it, changes it, or deletes it. Everything new is written to a separate folder.

Say you dropped a file called **Lecture 4.mp4**. You will find a folder named after today's date, so no two runs can ever overwrite each other.

```
D:\My Lectures\2026-08-23\Lecture 4\  
|  
+-- Lecture 4.mp3           to listen to, and for NotebookLM  
+-- Lecture 4__16k_mono.flac for your transcription pipeline  
+-- ffmpeg_run.log         a record, only needed if something failed
```

Which one do I use?

You want to listen to it	the MP3
You are uploading to NotebookLM	the MP3
You want a written transcript	the FLAC

THE FLAC SOUNDS ODD, AND THAT IS CORRECT

Play it and it will sound flat, quiet and slightly lifeless. That is deliberate. It has been converted to mono, reduced to 16 kHz and volume-levelled, because that is exactly what transcription software wants. It is not broken. For listening, use the MP3.

Do not send the FLAC to NotebookLM. NotebookLM does not accept FLAC at all. Send it the MP3, which is sized to fit its 200 MB limit.

About the MP3 size

The MP3 is made in mono at 96 kbps. That is more than enough for speech, and it keeps a three-hour lecture at roughly 130 MB, comfortably inside NotebookLM's 200 MB per-file limit. In practice this means **one file, no splitting, every time**.

If a recording is long enough to go over the limit anyway, past about four and a half hours, the tool notices and also writes smaller pieces into an `mp3_parts` folder. The full MP3 stays where it is. Use whichever suits.

The tool tells you what happened in plain words. Here is every message it can show you, and what to do about each one.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
[ERROR] ffmpeg was not found	Part 1 Step 1 did not finish. Open a <i>new</i> terminal and try <code>ffmpeg -version</code> again, or switch to the manual method.
[ERROR] ffprobe was not found	You copied only <code>ffmpeg.exe</code> . Go back and copy <code>ffprobe.exe</code> as well. Both are required.
[WARN] Cannot write to F:\Lecture	That drive is not there. Nothing was lost. Your files went into <code>Extracted_Audio</code> next to the tool. Set your own folder using Part 1 Step 2.
[SKIP] No audio track in this file	The video is silent, or the audio track is missing. There is nothing to extract. Check the file plays with sound first.
[SKIP] File not found	The file was moved or renamed after you dragged it. Try again.
[SKIP] That is a folder	You dropped a folder rather than a file. Open it and drop the files inside.
[FAIL] ... See the messages above	Scroll up in the black window. FFmpeg prints the reason there. A damaged or half-downloaded source file is the usual cause.
The window flashes and vanishes	FFmpeg is missing, or Windows has blocked the file. Right-click <code>Audio_Extractor.bat</code> , choose Properties , tick Unblock if you see it, then OK.

The summary line

Every run ends with a single line that tells you how it went:

```
Finished. files: 3 ok: 3 failed: 0 skipped: 0
```

If **failed** and **skipped** are both zero, everything worked.

PART 5 Optional extras

safe to ignore

YOU MAY SKIP ALL OF PART 5

The defaults are right for almost everyone. This part exists only for the day you want something slightly different out of a single run.

Open the folder that contains `Audio_Extractor.bat`, click the address bar at the top of the window, type `cmd` and press Enter. A black window opens in that folder. Now you can add a switch to the end of the tool's name, like

this:

EXAMPLE: MP3 ONLY, SKIP THE TRANSCRIPTION FILE

```
Audio_Extractor.bat /notext "lecture.mp4"
```

ADD THIS	AND IT WILL
/nomp3	Skip the MP3 and make only the transcription file.
/notext	Skip the transcription file and make only the MP3.
/wav	Make a WAV instead of a FLAC for transcription.
/stereo	MP3 in stereo at 192 kbps. For music, not lectures.
/kbps 128	Set the MP3 bitrate yourself. Default is 96.
/copy	Also save an untouched, bit-perfect copy of the original audio.
/out "D:\Somewhere"	Save this one run somewhere else.
/?	Show the complete list on screen.

To see them all at any time, in that same window run:

```
Audio_Extractor.bat /?
```

Quick reference

Everything above, on one card.

SETUP	Install FFmpeg, then pick your output folder. Once, and never again.
USE	Drag the file onto Audio_Extractor.bat. Wait about 40 seconds. Done.
LISTEN	The .mp3
NOTEBOOKLM	The .mp3, sized to fit under 200 MB. Never the FLAC, it is not accepted
TRANSCRIBE	The .flac, the one that sounds flat on purpose
ORIGINALS	Never touched. Read only, always.
OFFLINE	Nothing is uploaded, so nothing can fail halfway
BROKE?	Read the black window. It says what went wrong, and Part 4 says what to do.